

CAMPAIGN BRIEF

BFCM 2026 Sales Campaign

Smash Balloon & WPChat

PREPARED BY
Lianne Laroya

FOR
**Zach Tirrell and
Joel Nilsson**

DATE
March 2026

CAMPAIGN WINDOW
Nov 18 – Dec 15, 2026

Executive Summary

BFCM 2026 represents our biggest revenue opportunity of the year and a chance to build meaningfully on our 2025 results. This brief outlines a coordinated, early-start campaign across Smash Balloon and WPChat, covering email strategy, landing page optimization, partner outreach, new experiments, and a clear measurement framework to track progress against our 2025 baseline.

Our 2025 BFCM campaign generated \$8,543.03 in Lindris-attributed email revenue, \$39,879.10 in OptinMonster-attributed revenue, and \$2,236.60 through partner outreach. In 2026, we are focused on three strategic shifts:

- Starting planning earlier to allow for more strategic content creation and thorough review cycles
- Expanding our channel mix with new BF-specific Lite-upgrade pages and A/B tested emails
- Recovering OptinMonster impression volume to 2024 levels — the key driver behind a 37% OM revenue drop in 2025

 \$8,543 2025 email revenue (Lindris)	 \$39,879 2025 OptinMonster revenue	 \$2,236 2025 partner outreach revenue	 40 / 40 emails drafted & sent in 2025
--	---	---	---

Campaign Objectives

Our 2026 BFCM campaign is built around three core objectives:

1. Drive Revenue Growth

- Grow Lindris-attributed email revenue beyond \$8,543.03 (2025 baseline)
- Increase Lite-to-Pro conversions during the campaign window (new metric — no 2025 baseline since upgrade pages did not exist)
- Scale partner outreach revenue above \$2,236.60

2. Improve Conversion Quality

- Address pricing page performance for WPChat with proactive CRO testing before October
- Improve email CTR and conversion rates through structured A/B testing
- Ensure every customer segment receives the most relevant offer via refined segmentation in Lindris

3. Establish a Repeatable Playbook

- Document all decisions, timelines, and results in a BFCM 2026 playbook to make 2027 planning even faster
- Define review and approval Service Level Agreements so the entire team is aligned during the campaign window

Audience Segmentation

Our email campaigns will target four distinct audience segments across Smash Balloon and WPChat, each receiving tailored messaging and offers:

Segment	Profile	Core Message	Primary CTA
Free / Lite Users	WordPress site owners using Smash Balloon or WPChat Lite. Active but not yet converted	Upgrade to Pro at our best price of the year	Lite Upgrade Page (BF theme) → Checkout
Existing Pro Customers	Current paying customers on single-site or multi-site plans	Upgrade your plan or add a second product at a steep discount	Upsell / All Access Bundle Page
Lapsed / Churned Users	Former customers or expired licenses	Come back at the lowest price we offer all year	Re-activation Offer Page
Organic Traffic (Cold)	New visitors arriving via blog, Google Ads, or partner referrals	Try the #1 social feed and live chat plugin for WordPress	OptinMonster campaign in blog posts → Pricing Page → Checkout

Channel Strategy

We will run a coordinated multi-channel campaign across owned and earned channels. The email channel remains our primary revenue driver, with supporting channels amplifying reach during the campaign window.

Channel	Brands	2025 Result	2026 Focus
Email (Lindris)	Smash Balloon + WPChat	\$8,543 (2025)	A/B test subject lines, CTAs, and send times; refine segmentation
OptinMonster	Smash Balloon + WPChat	\$39,879 (2025) / \$63,379 (2024)	Recover 2024 impression volume (263K vs 156K in 2025) — conversion rate held steady at ~2% both years, so volume is the only lever
PushEngage	Smash Balloon + WPChat	Active pushes in 2025	Sequence: teaser → launch → last chance with progressive urgency
In-Plugin Notifications	Smash Balloon + WPChat	Active in 2025	Personalize by plan type; Lite users see upgrade CTA, Pro users see bundle
Partner Outreach	WPChat focus	\$2,236 revenue (2025)	Structured outreach to 10+ AM partners + WPBeginner roundup by Sept

Email Campaign Architecture

In 2025 we sent 40 emails across 7 segments.

The 2026 program builds directly on that structure with targeted improvements per segment, a new Nov 18 early access experiment for Pro users, a Nov 23 general launch following 2025’s proven Monday-before-BF playbook, and a hybrid CTA page strategy.

Total for 2026: 44 emails across an extended Nov 18 – Dec 15 window.

Segment	2025 Emails	2026 Target	Key Change
Abandoned	6	6	Same structure; dates shift to match 2026 BF window + dedicated BF landing page
Cancelled	3	5	Dedicated BF landing page + new Nov 25 reminder + CM + GM extension
Basic/Plus/Elite	11	12	Early access Nov 18; Nov 23 becomes reminder; Dedicated BF landing page
Lite	10	11	Lite Upgrade Page as CTA throughout; Nov 25 reminder added
All-Access Bundle	3	5	Early access Nov 18; behavioral branching; Dedicated BF landing page + CM
Green Monday Pro	3	2	Tighter Dec 14–15 window + charity angle; Dedicated BF landing page
Green Monday Lite	3	2	Tighter Dec 14–15 window + charity + Lite Upgrade Page
All (Thanksgiving)	1	1	Nov 26 — same day as Thanksgiving 2026

Proposed 2026 Email Sequence

The table below mirrors the 2025 spreadsheet format.

Dates are based on Black Friday = Nov 27, 2026 (Thanksgiving = Nov 26, Cyber Monday = Nov 30, Green Monday = Dec 14). ★ = New in 2026 vs. 2025 cadence.

Send Date	Segment	Email #	Conditions	Theme	Content	Links to	Primary Creator
Nov 18	Basic/Plus/Elite	★ BP1	All Pro users	★ Early Access ★	Exclusive BF deal 5 days early — loyalty reward for being a Pro member	BF Landing Page (upgrade to All Access)	Lianne
Nov 18	All-Access Bundle	★ Bundle 1	All Bundle users	★ Early Access ★	Partner links, highlight WPChat	BF Landing Page (contains partner links, highlight WPChat)	Lianne
Nov 23	Abandoned	Ab1	All	BF Launch	Come back — our best deal of the year is live	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 23	Cancelled	C1	All	BF Launch	Come back at the lowest price we offer all year	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 23	Lite	★ Lite1	All	★ BF Launch ★	Upgrade to Pro at our best price of the year	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Nov 23	Basic/Plus/Elite	★ BP2	Received early access Nov 18	★ BF Reminder ★	Deal reminder — still live, don't miss out	BF Landing Page (upgrade to All Access)	Lianne
Nov 23	All-Access Bundle	★ Bundle 2	Received early access Nov 18	★ BF Reminder ★	Partner links, highlight WPChat	BF Landing Page (contains partner links, highlight WPChat)	Lianne
Nov 25	Abandoned	Ab2	Did NOT open Nov 23	BF Reminder	What you'll miss out on — deal ends this week	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 25	Cancelled	★ C2	Did NOT open Nov 23	★ BF Reminder ★	Re-engagement reminder — deal closes soon	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 25	Lite	Lite2	Did NOT open Nov 23	BF Reminder	Reminder with countdown timer — upgrade offer live	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Nov 25	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP3	Clicked ≥1 BF email	Partner Promo	Partner spotlight — WPForms BF deal	WPForms BF deal	Lianne
Nov 25	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP4	Did NOT open Nov 23	BF Reminder	Reminder — deal still live, expires soon	BF Landing Page (upgrade to All Access)	Lianne
Nov 26	All Segments	All1	All users	Thanksgiving	Heartfelt message from Zach — no sale push	smashballoon.com	Lianne
Nov 27	Lite	Lite3	Clicked Nov 23 or Nov 25	BF Cross-Sell	WPChat BF sale — get both plugins	wpchat.com/pricing	Lianne
Nov 27	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP5	Clicked any BF email	BF Cross-Sell	WPChat BF sale — get both plugins	wpchat.com/pricing	Lianne
Nov 28	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP6	Clicked ≥1 BF email	Small Business Saturday	Partner spotlight — MonsterInsights BF deal	MonsterInsights deal	Lianne
Nov 28	Lite	Lite4	Clicked ≥2 BF emails	Small Business Saturday	Partner spotlight — WP Mail SMTP BF deal	WP Mail SMTP deal	Lianne
Nov 28	Abandoned	Ab3	Did NOT open/click Nov 23 or Nov 25	Small Business Saturday	What you'll miss out on — ends soon	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 28	Lite	Lite5	Did NOT open/click any	Small Business Saturday	Reminder with countdown timer — ends soon	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne

Send Date	Segment	Email #	Conditions	Theme	Content	Links to	Primary Creator
			<i>email after Nov 23</i>				
Nov 28	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP7	<i>Did NOT open Nov 23 or Nov 25</i>	BF Reminder	Reminder — deal closing soon	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 28 (Sat)	Basic/Plus/Elite	★ BP8	<i>All</i>	★ SBS Extended ★	Small Biz Sat: extended value + All-Access Bundle highlight	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 28 (Sat)	Lite	★ Lite6	<i>All</i>	★ SBS Extended ★	Small Biz Sat: extended deal — still time to upgrade	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Nov 28 (Sat)	All-Access Bundle	Bundle 3	<i>All</i>	SBS Extended	Small Biz Sat: All-Access Bundle deal extended through weekend	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 29	Abandoned	Ab4	<i>All</i>	BF Ending Soon	Last chance — sale ends tonight (countdown timer)	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 29	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP9	<i>Did NOT open SBS email</i>	BF Ending Today	Ending Today (countdown timer)	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 29	Lite	Lite7	<i>Did NOT click any BF email in 6 days</i>	BF Ending Today	Ending Today (countdown timer)	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Nov 30 (CM)	Abandoned	Ab5	<i>All</i>	CM Launch	Cyber Monday sale — even bigger savings	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 30 (CM)	Cancelled	C3	<i>All</i>	CM Launch	Cyber Monday re-engagement offer	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 30 (CM)	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP10	<i>All</i>	CM Launch	Cyber Monday — All-Access Bundle deal	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Nov 30 (CM)	Lite	★ Lite8	<i>All</i>	★ CM Launch ★	Cyber Monday — upgrade to Pro today	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Nov 30 (CM)	All-Access Bundle	★ Bundle 4	<i>All</i>	★ CM Launch ★	Partner links, highlight WPChat	BF Landing Page (partner links, WPC)	Lianne
Dec 2	Abandoned	Ab6	<i>Did NOT click CM launch</i>	CM Extended	Extended 'til Friday — don't miss out	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 2	Cancelled	C4	<i>Did NOT click CM launch</i>	CM Extended	Extended 'til Friday — last chance to come back	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 2	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP11	<i>Did NOT click CM launch</i>	CM Extended	Extended 'til Friday — CM deal still live	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 2	Lite	Lite9	<i>Did NOT click CM launch</i>	CM Extended	Extended 'til Friday — upgrade offer still live	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Dec 4	Basic/Plus/Elite	BP12	<i>Did NOT open/click CM emails</i>	CM Ending Today	Ending Today + WPChat cross-sell	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 4	Lite	Lite10	<i>Did NOT open/click CM emails</i>	CM Ending Today	Ending Today (countdown timer)	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Dec 4	Cancelled	★ C5	<i>Did NOT click any email after BF launch</i>	★ CM Final Push ★	Last chance re-engagement — this is it	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 4	All-Access Bundle	★ Bundle 5	<i>Did NOT open/click CM emails</i>	★ CM Ending Today ★	CM ending — last chance for All-Access Bundle	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 4	Lite	★ Lite11	<i>Opened CM launch but did NOT convert</i>	★ CM Cross-Sell ★	WPChat Cyber Monday deal — get both plugins	wpchat.com/pricing	Lianne

Send Date	Segment	Email #	Conditions	Theme	Content	Links to	Primary Creator
Dec 14 (GM)	Basic/Plus/Elite	★ GMPPro 1	All	★ Green Monday ★	Sale + charity partner spotlight — give back while saving	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 14 (GM)	Lite	★ GMLite 1	All	★ Green Monday ★	Sale + charity angle + upgrade message	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne
Dec 15	Basic/Plus/Elite	★ GMPPro 2	Did NOT click Dec 14 launch	★ GM Ending Today ★	Ending Today — last chance of the season	BF Landing Page	Lianne
Dec 15	Lite	★ GMLite 2	All	★ GM Ending Today ★	Ending Today — last chance to upgrade	Lite Upgrade Page	Lianne

★ = New in 2026 vs. 2025 cadence Total emails: **44** (up from 40 in 2025)

Key Improvements vs. 2025

- **Nov 18 early access to Pro users (BPE + Bundle) — 5 days before the general launch on Nov 23. New experiment to reward loyalty and drive early revenue before the peak window.**
 - A/B test on this email: urgency subject line vs. status subject line (“You’re getting it first”)
- **Nov 23 general launch follows 2025’s proven playbook (Monday before BF) for Lite, Abandoned, and Cancelled segments. BPE + Bundle receive a reminder email on Nov 23 instead, since they already got the deal Nov 18.**
- **Nov 25 Wednesday reminders added — following the same Mon-launch → Wed-reminder pattern from 2025. Covers non-clickers of the Nov 23 launch across all segments.**
- **Hybrid CTA page strategy — Lite Upgrade Page for Lite segment, dedicated BF landing page for all others.**
 - Reasoning: In 2024 we used a dedicated BF landing page and performance was strong. In 2025 we sent to the generic pricing page and email revenue was lower.
 - CRO best practice is message match: a subscriber who clicks “get your Black Friday deal” expects to land on a page that reinforces that context. A generic pricing page breaks that continuity and increases bounce.
 - For Lite users specifically, the Lite Upgrade Page is even stronger because it’s personalized to their current plan and shows the exact upgrade path.
 - Requires dev work to build the BF landing page — see Decisions Needed.
- **Cyber Monday 2026 = Nov 30 (Monday after Thanksgiving Nov 26). All CM emails shift accordingly; CM extended = Dec 2, CM ending = Dec 4 (Friday).**
- **Green Monday moves to Dec 14–15 — the actual Green Monday 2026 date (second Monday of December). Tighter 2-day window vs. 2025’s 5-day run; adds a charity partner angle to differentiate it from BF/CM.**
- **Cancelled segment strengthened: 3 → 5 emails, adding Nov 25 reminder and Cyber Monday final push.**
- **Partner promos remain gated to high-engagement users (1+ or 2+ clicks) to protect list quality and maximize relevance.**

Key Experiments for 2026

With a full campaign cycle of experience to build from, we are introducing four structured experiments this year. Each has a clear hypothesis, test mechanism, and success metric so we can make data-driven decisions for 2027.

Experiment	What We Test	Success Metric
Email A/B Testing	Subject line formulas (urgency vs. value vs. curiosity), CTA button copy, preview text, and send time	Lift in open rate and CTR vs. 2025 per-email averages
Lite Upgrade Pages	Dedicated Lite-to-Pro upgrade landing pages for both Smash Balloon and WPChat with BFCM-specific overlays	Lite-to-Pro conversion rate during BFCM window (new baseline)
Pricing Page CRO	A/B test layout, social proof placement, pricing anchoring, and CTA variants on the WPChat pricing page	Pricing page conversion rate vs. BFCM 2025

Partner Outreach Program

In 2025, partner placements generated \$2,236.60 with minimal structure. In 2026, we will build this into a systematic program:

- Build a master outreach list of 10+ AM ecosystem partners (WPForms, MonsterInsights, WPBeginner, etc.) by June
- Contact each partner with a co-promotion proposal by July, well ahead of their own BFCM planning cycles
- Track each placement with unique UTM parameters to attribute revenue per partner
- Target: \$4,000+ in partner-attributed revenue (2x 2025)

Campaign Timeline

By moving planning significantly earlier, we are building in adequate review time at every stage and avoiding last-minute production pressure.

Phase	Timeline	Key Deliverables
Strategy Lock	March – April 2026	Finalize discount structures, offer tiers, Green Monday charity partner and channel plan. Align with Joel + Zach.
Asset Development	May – July 2026	Build Lite upgrade pages (BF theme), run pricing page CRO tests, initiate partner outreach, begin landing page design for BFCM-specific variants.
Content Creation	August – September 2026	Draft all email copy (target: 44 emails). Confirm list of partners and draft emails for partners.
Review & QA	October 2026	Full email review cycle with Joel. Lindris segment validation and pre-send QA. Landing page BFCM variants live in staging. All assets approved.
Campaign Launch	Nov 18 – 27, 2026	Nov 18: Early access email to Pro users (BPE + Bundle). Nov 23: General BF launch (Lite, Abandoned, Cancelled) + BPE/Bundle reminder. Nov 25: Wednesday reminders.

Phase	Timeline	Key Deliverables
		Nov 26: Thanksgiving. Nov 27: Black Friday behavioral sends begin.
BFCM Core Window	Nov 27 – Dec 4, 2026	Full campaign active across all channels. Daily Lindris check-ins. Cyber Monday Nov 30. CM Extended Dec 2. Final CM sends Dec 4. Real-time monitoring and pivots throughout.
Extension: Green Monday	Dec 14 – 15, 2026	Green Monday launches on Dec 14 (BPE + Lite) with charity partner angle. Ending Today sends Dec 15 for non-clickers.
Debrief & Playbook	December 2026	Full campaign performance report vs. 2025 baseline. Document wins, learnings, and recommendations. Publish BFCM 2027 starting brief.

Success Metrics

Metrics are tracked across three channels: email (Lindris + GA4), OptinMonster, and partner outreach. The combined 2025 baseline across all three is approximately \$50,659. The 2026 goal is to meaningfully grow total campaign revenue, with OM impression recovery being the single highest-leverage opportunity.

Metric	2025 Baseline	2026 Target	Owner	Priority
Email Revenue (Lindris)	\$8,543.03	> \$11,000 (+29%)	Lianne	P0
Email Revenue (GA4)	\$5,454.29	> \$7,500 (+38%)	Lianne	P0
OM Revenue (smashballoon.com)	\$39,879.10 (2025) / \$63,378.92 (2024)	> \$45,000	Lianne + Aman	P0
OM Impressions	156,684 (2025) / 263,208 (2024)	> 200,000	Lianne + Aman	P0
OM Conversion Rate	2.01% (2025) / 1.97% (2024)	Maintain ~2%+	Lianne + Aman	P1
Partner Revenue	\$2,236.60	> \$4,000 (+79%)	Lianne	P0
Pricing Page Conv. Rate	Baseline TBD (Aug test)	Beat baseline by 10%+	Lianne + Aman + Dev	P0
Lite-to-Pro Conversions	None (new metric)	Establish Year 1 baseline	Lianne + Aman + Dev	P1
Email A/B Test Wins	No tests in 2025	3+ documented wins	Lianne	P1
Total Emails Drafted	40 / 40	44 / 44	Lianne	P1

Key insight — OptinMonster:

The OM conversion rate held steady at ~2% in both 2024 (1.97%) and 2025 (2.01%), which tells us the popup experience, offer, and targeting are all working.

The \$23,500 revenue gap is entirely an impressions problem: 263K impressions in 2024 vs. 156K in 2025, a 40% drop.

At a stable 2% conversion rate and ~\$12 average order, every 10,000 impressions recovered = roughly \$2,400 in OM revenue.

The impression drop traces back to declining organic search traffic. AI Overviews are answering informational queries (how-tos, comparisons, roundups) directly in Google, reducing click-throughs to the site even when rankings hold. This is a structural shift.

- For 2026, recovering OM impressions means shifting traffic strategy toward channels AI Overview can't touch:
- Paid search on branded + transactional queries during the BFCM window ("Smash Balloon Black Friday deal") - high purchase intent, AI Overview rarely appears on commercial queries
 - Partner placements - referral traffic from WPBeginner, WPForms, MonsterInsights arrives with buying intent and no suppression cookies
 - Email click-throughs - every link click from the 45-email sequence is a direct site visit and a potential OM impression
 - Paid retargeting on Meta/Google Display - re-engage past visitors during the 3-week window

Notes on attribution:

- Primary email metric: Lindris-attributed revenue (most complete view of email performance)
- OM revenue: OptinMonster dashboard attribution (smashballoon.com); tracked separately from email
- Partner revenue: tracked via UTM parameters per partner placement

Decisions Needed from Leadership

To move forward with the strategy and timeline above, we need alignment on the following by end of April 2026:

Decision	Options	Owner
Discount structure for BFCM 2026	% off vs. fixed pricing vs. bundle deal	Zach + Joel
Build a dedicated BF landing page?	Recommended: Yes — reverting to 2024 approach. Requires dev work by Oct. Lite segment will point to Lite Upgrade Page instead.	Zach + Joel + Lianne + Aman + Dev
Green Monday charity partner	Select partner org by April for Dec 14–15 campaign	Zach + Joel
Pricing page CRO A/B test	Confirm dev availability to run WPChat pricing page test May–Aug	Zach + Joel + Lianne + Dev

Questions or feedback? Reach out to Lianne Laroya via Slack or email
llaroya@awesomemotive.com